MARVIN MORGAN

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Education

University of California, Santa Barbara — Santa Barbara, CA
Candidate for Doctorate of Philosophy in Physics & Astrophysics — Graduation: 06/2027

University of Texas at Austin — Austin, TX
Master of Science in Astronomy & Astrophysics — Graduation: 12/2023

University of Pennsylvania — Philadelphia, PA
Master of Science in Physics & Astronomy
Bachelor of Arts in Physics & Astrophysics — Graduation: 05/2021

Honors & Awards

Graduate:

McDonald Observatory Teten Excellence Fellowship Recipient — 2025
Frank N. Edmonds, Jr. Memorial Fellowship Award Recipient — 2024–2025
College of Natural Sciences Graduate Continuing Fellowship — 2023–2024
College of Natural Sciences Mentoring Dean's Strategic Fellowship — 2021–2023

Undergraduate:

Prestigious Roy and Diana Vagelos Science Challenge Award — 2020–2021

Relevant Experience

Teaching Assistant
Fall 2024: Astronomy 307 Introduction to Astronomy for Majors — Austin, TX

Teaching Assistant
Spring 2021: Physics 102 General Physics: Electromagnetism — Philadelphia, PA

Service, Leadership, & Outreach

Gaia DR4 Pre-Vetting Survey Collaboration (17 nights, Lick & Keck) — 2025–Present
California Planet Search Team (3 nights, Keck) — 2026–Present
Habitable Worlds Observatory Pre-Vetting (4 Nights, Keck) — 2025–2026
Graduate-Undergrad Mentorship in astronoMY (GUMMY) Mentor — 2022–2025
The National Society of Black Physicists UT Austin Recruiter — 2023–2025
UPenn Division I Track and Field Captain & Record holder — 2018–2021

Grants

James Webb Space Telescope, NASA/STScI
$142K (PI) Imaging a Hidden Super-Jupiter Accelerating an M-dwarf — Cycle 4 GO

Selected PI/Co-PI Observing Proposals

JWST Cycle 4 GO 9091, PI Morgan, Imaging a Hidden Super-Jupiter Accelerating its Metal-rich M-dwarf Host, 16.1 hours awarded

ESO / VLTI-GRAVITY (ATs), PI Morgan, Probing the Influence of Distant Binary Companions on

Long-Period Giant Planets, 9 hr awarded, equivalent to 4 nights, (FTC 117, 2026)

ESO / VLTI-GRAVITY (UTs), Co-PI Morgan, Constraining Migration Pathways of Hot Jupiters in Stellar Binaries with Precise Binary Orbits, 18 hr awarded, equivalent to 8 nights, (P117, 2025)

Keck / NIRC2, Co-PI Morgan, Constraining Migration Pathways of Hot Jupiters in Stellar Binaries with Precise Binary Orbits, 6 nights awarded through UCO Access (2026A, 2026B)

HET / HPF, PI Morgan, Testing the Origin of Warm Jupiters with Population-Level Eccentricities, 82 hours awarded through UT Access (T22-1, T22-2, T22-3, T23-1)

MINERVA-Australis, PI Morgan, 225 hours awarded through NOIRLab / NN-EXPLORE program (2022A, 2022B, 2023A)

JWST Cycle 3 GO 6139, PI Bowler, Angular Momentum Architecture of the HR 8799 Planetary System, Co-I, 23.16 hours awarded

First Authored Publications (6)

(1) ***TIDES I. Highly Eccentric and Misaligned Binary Companions to Hot Jupiters***
Morgan, M., Xuan, J. W., Bowler, B. P., Franson, K., et al., 2026, AJ, accepted

(2) ***Evidence for an Outer Giant Planet or Brown Dwarf in the 51 Pegasi System***
Morgan, M., Bowler, B. P., Franson, K., Jiang, L., et al., 2026, AJ, 172, 60.

(3) ***Exploring Warm Jupiter Migration Pathways with Eccentricities. II. Correlations with Host Star Properties and Orbital Separation***
Morgan, M., Bowler, B. P., Tran, Q. H., et al., 2026, AJ, 171, 19.

(4) ***Exploring Warm Jupiter Migration Pathways with Eccentricities. I. Catalog of Uniform Keplerian Fits to Radial Velocities of 200 Warm Jupiters***
Morgan, M., Bowler, B. P., Tran, Q. H., et al., 2025, ApJS, 280, 76.

(5) ***Signs of Similar Stellar Obliquities for Hot and Warm Jupiters Orbiting Cool Stars***
Morgan, M., Bowler, B. P., Tran, Q. H., et al., 2024, AJ, 167, 48.

(6) ***Collisional Growth Within the Solar System's Primordial Disk and Timing of the Giant Planet Instability***
Morgan, M., Seligman, D., & Batygin, K., 2021, ApJL, 917, L8.

Contributions (4)

(1) Rotation Periods, Inclinations, and Obliquities of Cool Stars Hosting Directly Imaged Substellar Companions: Spin–Orbit Misalignments Are Common
Bowler, B. P., Tran, Q. H., Zhoujian, Z., **Morgan, M.**, et al. 2022, AJ, 165, 164B

(2) One-third of Sun-like stars are born with misaligned planet-forming disks
Biddle, L. I., Bowler, B. P., **Morgan, M.**, et al. 2025, Nature, 644, 356.

(3) Gaia Exoplanet Orbits, Demographics, and Evolution Survey (GEODES). I.
Van Zandt, J., Bowler, B. P., Petigura, E. A., Franson, K., Xuan, J. W., **Morgan, M.**, et al., 2026, ApJ, 1006, 222.

(4) The Optical Photometric Variability of Herbig Ae/Be Stars from TESS
Cody, A. M., Hillenbrand, L. A., Chandragiri, S., **Morgan, M.**, 2025, ApJ, 994, 253.

Contributed Talks

Seminar Talk	University of Hawai‘i IfA, SPLAT seminar	2026
Contributed Talk	Keck Science Meeting	2026
Contributed Talk	On the Shoulders of Giants: Turin, Italy	2026
Seminar Talk	University of Hawaii IfA, SPLAT seminar	2026
Seminar Talk	University of California, Santa Cruz, PLUNCH seminar	2026
Seminar Talk	University of Michigan, SPF Seminar	2026
Seminar Talk	Michigan State University Astronomy Seminar	2026
Contributed Talk	OHP – 51 Pegasi b: St-Michel-l’Observatoire, France	2025
Contributed Talk	OWL Conference, Santa Cruz, California	2025
Contributed Talk	Exoplanets 5, Leiden, Netherlands	2024
Contributed Talk	ERES VIII, Yale University	2023